



QUANT LAB USA INC

Custom CRM RFP Template (2026 Edition)

A 15-section ready-to-fill RFP template plus weighted scoring rubric for buying a custom CRM build. Copy, brand it, send to three to five shops, and pick the right vendor with internal consensus instead of internal politics.

Published 2026 - Free founder and operator resource
quantlabusa.dev/resources

Table of Contents

- Section 1 - Company Background and Decision Context
- Section 2 - Current-State Stack
- Section 3 - Functional Requirements
- Section 4 - Integration Requirements
- Section 5 - User Experience and Workflow
- Section 6 - Data Model
- Section 7 - Reporting and Analytics
- Section 8 - Security, Compliance, and Audit
- Section 9 - Deployment, Hosting, and SLAs
- Section 10 - Team and Engagement Model
- Section 11 - Pricing and Commercial Terms
- Section 12 - Post-Launch Support
- Section 13 - Weighted Scoring Rubric
- Section 14 - Evaluation Timeline
- Section 15 - Required Vendor Exhibits

About this document

This document is a free resource published by QUANT LAB USA INC, a Georgia-incorporated technology company building custom business software, SaaS platforms, and security engineering for mid-market and SMB operators. It is informational only and does not constitute legal, tax, accounting, or financial advice. Always verify decisions with a qualified licensed professional in your jurisdiction.

Section 1

Company Background and Decision Context

Use this section to give bidders the context they need to write a meaningful response. The goal is to help vendors decide whether to bid and to anchor their responses to your actual situation rather than to a generic template.

Template Prompts

- Company name, primary industry, employee count, ARR range.
- Brief description of the business and primary revenue model.
- Current pipeline and customer count (orders of magnitude are fine).
- What is prompting the CRM build at this time - what changed?
- What does 'doing nothing' look like in 12 months?
- Decision timeline: when do you intend to award the contract and when do you need the system live?

Tip: Vendors will read this section first. A thoughtful 2-page context section will produce materially better proposals than a 1-paragraph stub.

Section 2

Current-State Stack

Document the systems you currently use and the integration points that matter. Vendors need this to scope the integration surface accurately.

- Current CRM (Salesforce, HubSpot, Pipedrive, spreadsheets, etc.).
- Customer data warehouse (Snowflake, BigQuery, Redshift, Databricks, none).
- Marketing automation platform.
- Customer support tool (Zendesk, Intercom, Help Scout, etc.).
- Billing and payments stack (Stripe, NetSuite, QuickBooks, etc.).
- Email and calendar (Google Workspace, Microsoft 365).
- Data volumes: contacts, accounts, deals, activities (orders of magnitude).
- Approximate daily integration volume across the most-traversed integrations.

Section 3

Functional Requirements

Distinguish must-have, should-have, and nice-to-have requirements. Bidders use this to scope the v1 versus phased rollout.

Lead and Contact Management

- Lead capture from web forms, email, and inbound calls.
- Lead enrichment (Clearbit, ZoomInfo, or in-house).
- Lead scoring rules and lifecycle stages.
- Duplicate detection and merging.

Deal and Pipeline Management

- Deal stages and pipeline visualization.
- Forecast roll-up across reps and segments.
- Deal-room collaboration (notes, docs, activity log).
- Quote and proposal generation - in-CRM or via integration.

Activity and Communication

- Email-to-CRM (BCC capture or native sync).
- Calendar integration with meeting note capture.
- Click-to-call telephony integration if used.
- Templated email sends with tracking.

Section 4

Integration Requirements

List required integrations explicitly. For each, note whether it is read-only, write-only, or bidirectional, and the latency tolerance (real-time, hourly, daily).

System	Direction	Latency	Day-1?
Stripe	Read	Real-time	Yes
Data Warehouse	Write	Hourly	Yes
Marketing Automation	Bidirectional	Real-time	Yes
Support Tool	Read	Real-time	Yes
NetSuite/QuickBooks	Write	Daily	12-month
LinkedIn Sales Navigator	Read	Real-time	Nice-to-have

Section 5

User Experience and Workflow

Provide a sample user journey for each of the three highest-volume CRM roles: rep, manager, and ops. Vendors will use these journeys to scope UI and flows.

Sample Rep Daily Workflow

- Morning - inbox sweep, prioritize follow-ups based on activity feed.
- Mid-morning - sequenced outbound activity, log calls and emails.
- Afternoon - deal updates, pipeline review, manager 1:1 prep.
- End of day - notes on day's deals, plan tomorrow.

Sample Manager Weekly Workflow

- Monday - pipeline review with reps, forecast roll-up.
- Wednesday - mid-week intervention on stalled deals.
- Friday - reporting to leadership, segment performance review.

Section 6

Data Model

List the core objects, key fields, and key relationships. Vendors will use this to scope the schema and any custom object work.

- **Account:** name, domain, industry, size, ARR, owner, status, custom segmentation fields.
- **Contact:** name, email, phone, title, account_id, role, last_activity.
- **Deal:** name, account_id, stage, value, probability, close_date, owner.
- **Activity:** type, contact_id, deal_id, timestamp, notes.
- **Custom objects unique to your business:** describe each.

Section 7

Reporting and Analytics

Describe the dashboards your business runs today and any additional views the new CRM must support.

- Pipeline by stage, by rep, by segment.
- Forecast accuracy over time.
- Win rate by source, by segment, by deal size.
- Activity volume by rep with conversion correlation.
- Custom executive dashboards.
- Export to BI tools (Looker, Mode, Hex, Tableau).

Section 8

Security, Compliance, and Audit

State your security posture requirements and the regulatory regimes your data lives under.

- SOC 2 status of bidder (Type I, Type II, in process, none).
- Encryption at rest and in transit standards.
- Role-based access control granularity required.
- IP allowlisting or VPN-only access requirements.
- Audit logging - what events, retained for how long.
- Regulatory regimes that apply to your data (HIPAA, PCI, GDPR, CCPA, GLBA).
- Data residency requirements.
- Single sign-on (SAML, OIDC) requirement.

Section 9

Deployment, Hosting, and SLAs

Specify your deployment preferences and the service-level expectations.

- Cloud preference (AWS, GCP, Azure, agnostic).
- Multi-tenant vs. single-tenant.
- Uptime SLA target (99.5%, 99.9%, 99.95%).
- Incident response SLA (response time, resolution time).
- Disaster recovery RPO and RTO targets.
- Maintenance window expectations.

Section 10

Team and Engagement Model

Describe what you expect from the vendor team and what your team commits.

From the Vendor

- Team composition (engineering / PM / design / QA / support).
- Named senior engineer who will work on this build.
- Communication cadence and channels.
- Demos and review cadence.
- Time zone coverage.

From Your Side

- Project sponsor (executive).
- Product owner (operational lead).
- SME availability for working sessions.
- QA and UAT participation.

Section 11

Pricing and Commercial Terms

Be explicit about commercial preferences and the contract terms that matter.

- Pricing model: fixed-fee, time-and-materials, milestone-based, hybrid.
- Payment terms (NET 30, milestone payments, retainer).
- Source code ownership at end of engagement.
- Open-source licensing constraints.
- Termination terms.
- Indemnification and liability cap.
- Standard contract red-flag checklist for response review.

Red flag: A bidder unwilling to discuss source code ownership in the response phase will be more difficult to negotiate with later. Surface this in the RFP, not in the final-round contract review.

Section 12

Post-Launch Support

Define expectations for the first 90 days post-launch and the ongoing engagement.

- Warranty period and what is included.
- Bug-fix SLA for critical, high, medium, and low severity.
- Maintenance retainer terms post-warranty.
- Feature-enhancement engagement model post-launch.
- Knowledge transfer plan if engagement winds down.

Section 13

Weighted Scoring Rubric

Default scoring rubric below. Re-weight for your specific situation before sending the RFP. Each dimension is scored 0-10 by your internal scorers and multiplied by the weight.

Dimension	Default Weight	Re-weight For
Technical fit	30%	Higher if integration depth is unusual.
Team quality	25%	Higher if engagement length exceeds 6 months.
Cost transparency	20%	Higher if budget is tight or fixed.
Integration depth	15%	Higher if integration count is 5+ on day 1.
Post-launch support	10%	Higher if internal eng capacity is light.

Section 14

Evaluation Timeline

Standard three-week vendor response window. Pad timeline conservatively - scoring takes longer than you expect.

Week	Activity
Week 1	RFP sent to 3-5 bidders. Q&A period open.
Week 2	Bidders work; mid-week Q&A response published to all bidders.
Week 3	Bidders submit responses by EOD Friday.
Week 4	Internal scoring; finalist interview prep.
Week 5	Finalist interviews with top 2 bidders.
Week 6	Final selection, contract negotiation, signature.

Finalist Interview Questions

- Walk us through a recent build of similar scope.
- Who specifically from your team will work on this build?
- How do you handle scope changes mid-engagement?
- What is your worst-case engagement story and what did you learn?
- What's the single most important question we haven't asked?

Section 15

Required Vendor Exhibits

Specify the artifacts you require bidders to include with their response.

- 2-3 case studies of similar builds.
- 3 reference contacts (with permission to call).
- Sample master services agreement.
- Standard security questionnaire response.
- CVs of named team members.
- Pricing breakdown with assumptions documented.
- Estimated timeline with phase milestones.
- List of risks the bidder sees in the engagement.

Contact & Next Steps

Ready to act on what is in this document?

If the contents of this PDF prompted a question you want a second set of eyes on, or if you are ready to scope a related engagement, we run a 20-minute discovery call at no cost. The conversation is structured: 5 minutes on your context, 10 minutes on the specific decision in front of you, 5 minutes on what good next steps look like.

- Book a 20-minute scoping call: quantlabusa.dev/contact
- Learn about our Custom CRM Development practice: quantlabusa.dev/services/custom-crm-development
- Browse our full resources library: quantlabusa.dev/resources
- Read recent case studies: quantlabusa.dev/work
- Pricing and discovery sprint options: quantlabusa.dev/pricing

Who is QUANT LAB USA?

QUANT LAB USA INC is a Georgia-incorporated technology consultancy. We build custom business software, SaaS platforms, payments and licensing infrastructure, and security engineering for mid-market and SMB operators. We are deliberately structured as a small, senior-engineering-led practice - the people on your scoping call are the people who build the system. If a custom build is on the table, we typically begin with a paid discovery sprint that produces wireframes, a database schema, and a phased build estimate.

QUANT LAB USA INC

Georgia C-Corporation - SOS #26086454 - EIN 42-2039870

Web: quantlabusa.dev - Email: hello@quantlabusa.dev

Resources library: quantlabusa.dev/resources